

ILLITERACY IN STATE FOUND TO BE ON DECREASE

Clackamas County Ranks Low On New List; Figures for Oregon City Show Smaller Percentage Below Average.

REPORT IS ISSUED BY J. A. CHURCHILL

Improvement of Conditions Is Aim of Work Now Being Conducted through Schools.

SALEM, Feb. 4.—That illiteracy is on the decrease throughout the state, despite a substantial increase in the population, is the indication of a report completed today by State Superintendent of Public Instruction.

Clackamas county ranks 31st in the list with 383 given as illiterate. This, however, is not figured upon a basis of population, but gives the actual number. Oregon City, however, ranks well, with but 52 illiterates, the 15th in number in the list of cities in the state.

In 1910, according to the report, there were 10,347 so-called illiterates in Oregon, while the census for 1920 disclosed 9,317 illiterates. In 1910 the percentage of illiteracy was 1.9 per cent, while in 1920 it was 1.5 per cent. During the same period the population of the state increased from 672,765 to 783,389.

"The chief purposes of the school system is to eliminate illiteracy," Mr. Churchill said in his report. "The fact that illiteracy is decreasing would indicate that the schools are functioning properly, and that the people are fully aware of the benefits to be derived from education. To keep ahead of ignorance the educational institutions must progress in common with other lines of activity."

"It has been proved that illiteracy does not tend to promote good government, and on the contrary has furnished material for persons who would overthrow our public institutions. The people of Oregon should do more to encourage their schools and should give more time and thought to making their schools efficient if they would overcome the effects of illiteracy."

31 TAKE COLLEGE WORK THROUGH MAIL COURSES

UNIVERSITY OF OREGON, Eugene, Feb. 2.—(Special.)—Thirty persons in Clackamas county enrolled with the extension division of the University.

According to the extension division records the majority of these are teachers and subjects dealing with education are the most popular. Short story writing ranks second in popularity and journalism foots the list with but one advocate.

Oregon City leads in enrollment with 9, followed in turn by Milwaukie with 5, Willamette 4, Canby 3, Oswego and Boring 2 and Molalla, Gladstone, West Linn, Clackamas, Eagle Creek and Oak Grove with 1.

Those taking courses from Oregon City are: Mrs. Evangeline Hutchinson, Clarence D. Cannon, Edwin G. Godwin, Gussie Hull, Wilfred W. Davis, Vernice Robbins, Mrs. Claire Chaney, Alma Litzberg and Olive A. Whipple; Milwaukie: Ben Fleishman, Margaret Dickover, A. C. Hathaway, Lynda Cowell, B. S. Wakefield; Willamette: Mrs. Fern Mercer Porter, Mrs. Mae E. Baty, Florence Fromong and Mabel Larson; Canby: Myrtle Birtchett, Myrtle King and Wayne E. Grevelly; Boring: Dorothy Herrich and Beatrice Rolfe; Oswego: Harry Garesline and Mrs. M. Griffin; Molalla: R. W. Rose; Gladstone: Shirlee Swallow; Eagle Creek: Mrs. L. Baumgartner; Oak Grove: Roy Stroud; West Linn: Mrs. Morris Hedden and Clackamas: Flossie Pierce.

Regular university credit is given for work done through the extension division and may be used for entrance to the University or in obtaining a degree.

During the year 1921 there were 1136 enrolled in the correspondence school alone while during the fall term there were 1113 enrolled in the classes conducted by the division in Portland.

ARBUCKLE JURY HANGS

SAN FRANCISCO, Feb. 3.—Roscoe (Patty) Arbuckle has failed a second time to win vindication on charges of having taken the life of Virginia Rappe.

The jury in his second trial, after more than 40 hours of deliberation, came into court at 11:30 a. m. today and reported a disagreement.

Ten members of the jury stood for acquittal and two for conviction on the final ballot.

The jury was discharged immediately after the report was read by the foreman.

A date for a third trial for Arbuckle will be set Monday.

FRANCE TO GO TO PARLEY

PARIS, Feb. 2.—Determined not to let the grass grow under his feet, Premier Poincare is actively working on foreign problems and virtually decided yesterday that France would be represented at the international economic conference at Genoa.

No postponement of the Genoa meeting is looked for her, despite the attitude of several governments in this respect. M. Poincare is planning to make a careful study of the program for the conference with the assistance of experts.

OREGON CITY DEBATERS WIN TRIANGLE CONTEST

Local Teams Win In Both Encounters Scoring Six of Possible Eight Points.

Oregon City High school won the first debate of the season Friday night in a triangular contest with West Linn and Park Rose.

At Oregon City, the locals defeated Park Rose 2 to 1. At West Linn, Oregon City defeated the west siders 2 to 1 and at Park Rose West Linn won from Park Rose, 3 to 0. Scores are figured by the addition of the total of judges' votes, allowing one extra point to a team for each victory. This makes the score: Oregon City, 6; West Linn, 5; Park Rose, 1.

The question was: "Resolved that the Plumb Plan for the control and management of the railways of the United States should be enacted into law."

The Oregon City teams were: Affirmative, Gordon Hannaford, and Gladys Hannaford. Negative, Marguerite Jackson and Eloy Anderson. The Oregon City coaches were Miss Doris Miller, Carl Landerholm, Miss Marjorie Little and W. L. Arant.

FILM DIRECTOR IS THOT KILLED FOR REVENGE

LOS ANGELES, Cal., Feb. 2.—William D. Taylor, director in chief for one of the largest film companies operating here, and nationally known in the motion picture industry, was found dead at his home here early today, under circumstances that the police said indicated murder. He had been shot through the neck. At first investigation it was thought he had suffered a hemorrhage, but closer examination disclosed the bullet wound.

The body was found near a desk in his room, upon which there was a canceled check. The wound, according to the police, indicated that the shot was fired from behind Taylor by some person standing up while Taylor apparently was seated before the desk examining the check. It went through the neck, ranging downward and penetrating the heart.

Among the latest persons known to have visited William D. Taylor, motion picture director, was Mabel Normand, film comedienne. It was announced tonight by the police detectives who are investigating.

Miss Normand was questioned by the police who said she talked unhesitatingly of the visit. She had stopped at Taylor's apartments to return a book which he had lent her, she said, and talked with him regarding recent robberies of his home.

Belief that Mr. Taylor was shot for revenge, was expressed late today by police investigators. This statement was made by more than a score of Mr. Taylor's acquaintances.

BONUS PLAN ADVANCED

WASHINGTON, Feb. 2.—The soldiers' bonus should be paid out of special taxes, such as increased first and second-class postage and tobacco levies. Secretary Mellon declared today before the house ways and means committee.

Secretary Mellon reiterated his belief that it would be impracticable to depend upon the foreign debt for financing the proposed "five way" adjusted compensation plan, because the revenue from the source is problematical.

RESCUE CREWS SENT

GATES, Pa., Feb. 2.—The bodies of nine miners, killed in an explosion in the Gates mine of the H. C. Frick Coke company here today, had been brought to the surface at noon from the entry, one and one-half miles from the foot of the shaft, where the accident occurred.

Twenty men, it was said, were still in the mine and experienced miners, working feverishly to reach them, expressed the opinion that all were dead.

Trained rescue crews from all parts of the Connellsville coal field are working in relays trying to reach the shut-in men.

FORD CONTRACT UP

WASHINGTON, Feb. 2.—Henry Ford's proposal for the government projects at Muscle Shoals, Alabama, was submitted today to congress by secretary Weeks for "such action as congress may deem appropriate." The only suggestion contained in the letter of transmission related to specific clauses in the contract and the desirability of amendments which would in the event the proposal be accepted by congress, further safeguard the government's interests.

NEW PREMIER ASKED

LONDON, Feb. 3.—The presidents of the Italian senate and chamber of deputies have advised King Victor Emmanuel to ask former Premier Giolitti to form a cabinet in succession to the Bonomi ministry. It is understood, says a Central News dispatch from Rome today.

TWO HURT IN CRASH

While traveling at a speed of 40 miles an hour the Atlantic express of the O.W. R. and N. was derailed at the S. P. & S. bridge near Celilo at 8:45 o'clock Friday night, resulting in the slight injury of Engineer Wilson and Fireman Williams of the train crew.

The express which is known as No. 4, left Portland at 5:30 o'clock Friday afternoon.

The wreck was caused by a boulder about 18 inches through and weighing about 100 pounds, which had fallen on the track at least 700 feet from where the engine lies on its side in the ditch. The boulder was apparently dislodged from the cliff above the tracks due to the melting of the ice and snow.

SMALL TRIAL SET

WAUKEGAN, Ill., Feb. 4.—Trial of Len Small, Illinois governor, on charges of conspiracy to juggle millions of dollars of state funds, was today set to start Monday, March 6. The date was set by Judge Claire Edwards in Lake county circuit court.

MARKET CONDITIONS IMPROVING

Lumber, Index of Industry If State Shows Decided Gain Toward Normal Basis In Past Few Weeks.

BY ROBERT E. SMITH,

President of the Lumbermen's Trust Company Bank, Portland, Ore.

Many encouraging factors enter into consideration of current business conditions. The situation in lumber is favorable, on the whole, and lumber is our most important industry in the Pacific Northwest.

There is a probability of a fair lumber business in the Spring. Although I adhere to my original idea, that we will not go ahead very rapidly until we have liquidation of another crop, it should be remembered that the farmer will begin buying lumber next Summer if he has a good crop in prospect, and the line yards must anticipate the farmers' anticipations, so that it will be necessary for the line yards to have a considerable amount of lumber delivered to them in the late Spring.

This, of course, means early orders, and the mills must turn this lumber out during the early Spring for it to arrive at its destination on time. Lumber stocks throughout the country are abnormally low and for the past six months lumber yards have been trading in order to take care of the limited demand so that any appreciable increase in retailers' demands must immediately be reflected in orders.

The logging camps are only running part of the time, but nearly all of them will be running part of the time, but nearly all of them will be running by January 15. All the Portland mills are now running. Eastern orders are coming in slowly, but there are a great many inquiries indicating that a better volume of Eastern business will be forthcoming in the Spring. There are some Australian inquiries, but Japan's demand seems to have slackened considerably. Southern California's demand is normal. There is a small supply of logs in the river. One of the encouraging features in the Pacific coast lumber business in the Spring is Argentine is shipping a great deal of wheat to Europe at low prices, which is the big reason for the limited amount of stuff that is being shipped out of the Portland harbor. Japanese buyers have been purchasing very little for the last two or three months, but it is the general impression that they will be in the market before many months. The flour mills are running spasmodically. Portland's output being 62 per cent of capacity and Puget Sound's 56 per cent. Millers are running on small profit in order to keep mills running part of the time and their men employed, as it is better to work on a narrower margin than a tie up the mills.

Generally speaking the wholesale grocery business is rather dull, though it is now showing improvement. There is a very fair demand for staples, but articles such as pineapple and semi-luxuries are not being freely purchased by the public. A very interesting feature of the situation is that staples are now almost down to pre-war levels, while the luxuries have not declined in price to anything near as great a degree. It is not impossible that there is something of a buyers' strike on these luxuries which may last until the price falls to the same level as the staples.

Standard packs of corn, beans and other staples of this character are now rising, owing solely to the fact that there have been such sharp declines in other prices. Stocks on the shelves of retail grocers are considerably under normal. The liquidation of retail grocery stock has been quite complete and they are now buying from hand to mouth. The number of orders which are received is equal to or above normal, but the amounts are small.

The city business of the wholesalers is better than the country business. Collections on both are quite satisfactory, except that in the wheat and cattle districts collections are rather slow, but the merchants, even in these districts, are in fair shape, although rather heavily indebted both to wholesalers and their local banks. However, they are getting by, and the jobbers are not worried over the final outcome, even in those districts.

Christmas business was better than last year in the department stores. The number of sales slips was above normal and credits are good. The stores are furnishing more houses than normal. Prices are down an average of 30 per cent below last year and prospects favor a good Spring business, as the working men seem to be on their feet.

The retail clothing business, prices are 40 per cent below levels of a year and a half ago, the largest drop being in suits, overcoats and pants. Stocks are getting very low, and this seems to conform to the belief of the Federal Reserve Bank of New York that there will be a retail stock buying movement in the Spring. This seems reasonable to me when you consider that in the New England district factories were running only 70 per cent normal and output was only sold 30 per cent ahead. That means that advance orders are only 21 per cent of normal and with the great potential wealth of this country it is reasonable to believe that, even though industry has not been employed to any great extent and the farmers' buying power is depleted, because consumption will fall off below 60 per cent and advance orders have been in a lower ratio than consumption.

Business was very quiet last Fall in wholesale dry goods, being about 20 per cent off normal, but it is picking up in fine shape now. There is a much better feeling among the druggists throughout the state. During the past few months, the number of orders and the number of items on each order have been away above normal but the total volume in dollars and cents has been less, owing to the fact that people are buying smaller quantities. There has also been a price decline.

However, it is an ill wind that blows no one good, and dealers have pointed out the fact that this and a large buying is a very good thing for local jobbers, because the retailers are discontinuing their large purchases direct from manufacturers in the East. I have noticed in all my talks with jobbers that they are cutting every corner and they are undoubtedly making every

effort to get all the extra business which locally belongs to the Oregon territory. All of this will be beneficial to them and this district. During the period of high prices and long profit, the loss of a small order was not a matter of vital importance, but ap- or business that they can. Collections are fair to good.

Losses from bad accounts are slightly higher than in previous years. Some items which have been reduced tremendously are now advancing in price, the situation being analogous to that of the diamond trade. For instance, rubber and leather goods are advancing in price because tremendous stocks of these commodities were in the hands of brokers when price declines came and as they were compelled to force their stuff on an unwilling market and there were some tremendous reductions in prices. Now that these brokers stocks are exhausted, wholesalers are buying direct from the manufacturers, and they are on a cost basis which is higher than the brokers' market.

In the luxury items of groceries, we find that luxuries such as pineapple and other high-class dainty morsels are not being readily absorbed by the public, although staples in the grocery line are finding a ready market. Now just the reverse is true in the sundry drug line. Luxuries, such as imported perfumes and fancy toilet articles are being enjoyed an abnormally high demand, but there is the fact that he price of these commodities have declined to a far greater degree than the staple line of drugs.

Perfumes which formerly cost \$10 an ounce are down to \$4 and \$4.50 an ounce. This is caused by large lines in the hands of brokers who were forced to unload. In imported goods there is an additional reason in the fact that the rate of exchange makes the high-class foreign article very cheap, and people are buying more of them than they did during normal times when the price was much higher. It seems to indicate that people are watching the market and are not buying unless they can pick up snags.

Respecting the salmon market, prices are strengthening and salmon is moving. You will recall that very large stocks were carried over from last year, and the price has been far below the cost of production even of present times. However, these stocks are now getting out of weak hands, who have been forced to sell because of their obligations, and are now largely concentrated in strong hands who have been holding their stocks for a price which will be equal to cost of production. Indications are, therefore, that the strengthening market will continue.

The shoe business was pretty slack last Fall—in fact, it was below normal, the only orders which were received being for very small amounts; that is to say, a retailer will

PUFFS, CAKES, AND WAFFLES BETTER MADE OF CORN MEAL

French Titles for The Average Menu

Aspic:—Savory jelly for cold dishes. Au gratin:—Dishes prepared with sauce and crumbs and baked.

Bouchees:—Very thing patties or cakes, as they indicate—mouthfuls. Baba:—A peculiar, sweet French yeast cake.

Bechamel:—A rich, white sauce made with stock.

Bisque:—A white soup made of shell fish.

To Blanch:—To place any article on the fire till it boils, then plunge it in cold water; to whiten poultry, vegetables, etc. To remove the skin by immersing in boiling water.

Bouillon:—A clear soup, stronger than broth, yet not so strong as consommé, which is "reduced" soup.

Braise:—Meat cooked in a closely covered stewpan, so that it contains its own flavor and those of the vegetables and flavorings put with it.

Brûlée:—A very rich, unsweetened French cake made with yeast.

Cannelloni:—Stuffed rolled-up meat.

Consommé:—Clear soup or bouillon boiled down till very rich, i. e. consumed.

Croquette:—A savory mince of fish or fowl, made with sauce into shapes, and fried.

Croustades:—Fried forms of bread to serve minces or other meats upon.

Entree:—A small dish, usually served between the courses at dinner.

Fondue:—A light preparation of melted cheese.

Fondant:—Sugar boiled and beaten to a creamy paste.

Hollandaise Sauce:—A rich sauce, something like hot mayonnaise.

Matelot:—A rich fish stew, with wine.

Meringue:—Sugar and white of egg beaten to sauc.

Marmade:—A liquor of spices, vinegar, etc., in which fish or meats are steamed before cooking.

Mirton:—Cold meat warmed in various ways, and dished in circular form.

Purée:—This name is given very thick soups, the ingredients for thickening which have been rubbed through a sieve.

Poulette Sauce:—A bechamel sauce, to which white wine and sometimes eggs are added.

Ragout:—A rich, brown stew, with mushrooms, vegetables, etc.

Piquante:—A sauce of several flavors, acid predominating.

Quenelles:—Potatoes with bread, yolks of eggs highly seasoned, and formed with a spoon to an oval shape; then poached and used either as a dish by themselves, or as a garnish.

Rechouille:—Cold dressing differing from mayonnaise, in that the eggs are hard boiled and rubbed in a mortar with mustard, herbs, etc.

Rissolo:—Rich mince of meat or fish rolled in thin pastry and fried.

Roux:—A cooked mixture of butter

order three pairs of shoes instead of two or three dozen of a particular kind. It is the same story that we have been getting all over of hand-to-mouth buying, and retail stocks are very low. The business picked up, however, just after Christmas, and is very satisfactory. All new sales collections are quite good, although there are still a great many frozen accounts, but these are gradually working out all right.

The wholesale price of shoes is 40 per cent less than a year ago. This, however includes working men's shoes which have declined in price much faster than the price of high grade shoes. Due principally to the fact that the Middle Western shoe factories have been able to effect substantial decreases in wages, whereas the shoe factories in New England, where the high priced shoes are made, have been under the domination of labor unions composed of foreigners under foreign control, and it was impossible to effect wage reductions.

Undoubtedly, however, the retail price of shoes has followed the wholesale price of shoes and naturally it cannot follow completely because there is considerable labor cost between the wholesalers' price and the consuming public and wages have not reduced ratably with the price of shoes. Nevertheless, all these things do not give us an alibi for the statement of one large dealer that shoe prices have dropped 20 per cent. That is to say, there is not sufficient reason for only a 20 per cent drop when the whole sale price has dropped 40 per cent, and I am inclined to believe that the actual drop in retail prices, exclusive of special sales, has been less than 20 per cent. I am also informed that shoe repairing business is working above normal, indicating that people are having their shoes half-soled instead of getting new ones.

Christmas business was below normal in the jewelry business, December running very appreciably under previous Decembers. However, business picked up right after Christmas, and so far in January the jewelry business is up 15 per cent above normal. Collections are better than normal and there seems to be an optimistic feeling among the jewelers. The Christmas trade was characterized by almost exclusive purchasing of necessities; that is to say, people this year confined their presents to those of a practical nature. Platinum has gone off in price considerably owing to a great extent to the competition of white gold. Jewelry which heretofore had been made of platinum is now being duplicated in white gold. It is very difficult to distinguish between them, and of course the gold is much less expensive than platinum. Gold jewelry is off about 10 or 15 per cent in price.

Diamonds went off 20 per cent in price last Summer, but are now back again to normal price. This fall in the price of diamonds was not occasioned by a short supply, but because the large diamond brokers were heavily in debt and were forced to liquidate and their large stock were thrown on the market at one time, which temporarily depressed it. Silver business, generally speaking, is in good condition. There was quite a drop in silverware just after the ship building closed, but it is now coming back in good shape.

GLADSTONE WINS

The Gladstone grammar school basketball team won over Milwaukie Friday evening by a score of 21 to 16. The game was played at West Linn, many attending from here. The personnel of the team as Franklyn Niles, center; Lacy Wallace and Ardon (Bobbie) Grasier, forwards; Melvin Carrothers and Wayne Vedder, guards.

Mrs. William Rivers is confined to her bed with pneumonia. Mrs. Conway mother of Mrs. Rivers, is staying with her during her illness.

The ladies of the Christian church have taken charge of the children of the Permenter family during the illness of the father. Mr. Permenter is recovering from a very serious attack of pneumonia. Mrs. Taft is caring for Helen, Mrs. Alexander for Lena and Mrs. Rankin, the 4-year-old baby.

Charles Rankin of O. A. C. is at the home of his brother S. H. Rankin, having been called here by the illness and death of his sister Mrs. J. R. Dallas.

Mr. and Mrs. W. E. Rauch entertained at dinner Monday evening in honor of the former's sister and husband, Captain and Mrs. J. O. Churchill of Portland. Covers were laid for seven. The evening was spent in music.

Mr. and Mrs. James Hatten and little daughter of Redland, were business visitors in Oregon City and Gladstone Tuesday.

Mrs. W. W. Leete spent Monday in Portland. She is the city that Mrs. Leete conducted business and visited with her daughter, Mrs. Dennis Crabtree.

Mrs. Carl Simmons is suffering an attack of lagroppe. Dennie (Toby) Wallace has returned to school at West Linn after an absence due to a severe cold. Toby was very unfortunate in having had all of his school books stolen.

Mrs. J. W. Aldworth are receiving congratulations upon the arrival of a lagroppe.

Wallace and McKenney contractors of Gladstone, have started work on the new sidewalk at 14th and Main streets in Oregon City.

Mrs. W. E. Hempstead is quite ill with a bad cold. Attorney William Hammond is confined to his home with a severe cold. Mrs. F. A. Burdon who has been critically ill with pneumonia at the St. Vincent hospital is very much improved.

Harland Weddle, son of Mr. and Mrs. Oren Weddle, is critically ill. Dr. McLean is in attendance. Funeral services were held from St. Mary's Catholic church in Portland, Tuesday morning, interment being made in Mt. Calvary cemetery.

Mrs. W. I. Rowan has received word of the improved condition of her father, Wm. Davis, who is at the home of his other daughter, Mrs. Barnette, of Salem. Mr. Davis is now able to sit up and plans to return to Gladstone as soon as he is able to travel.

GLADSTONE NEWS

Rev. Hardie Conner Condition Improves

Rev. Hardie Conner, pastor of the

Gladstone Baptist church who was seriously hurt, while boarding a street car, is still confined to his bed and will remain in the plaster cast for several months yet. Rev. Conner is improved to that extent that his friends are meeting with him at his home on Thursday evenings for their midweek prayer meeting. During Rev. Conner's illness the pulpit will be supplied each Sunday at eleven o'clock in the evening at 6:30 o'clock, Judge H. E. Cross will have charge of the young people's meeting.

W. W. G. Entertained By Mrs. Calvin Catto

Mrs. Elvin Catto entertained the members of the W. W. G. at her home Monday evening in a most pleasant manner.

The Catto home was decorated with red carnations and ferns. Delicious refreshments were served by the hostess, who was assisted by her mother Mrs. W. I. Rowan. Those enjoying the evening were Mrs. H. H. Hulbert, Mrs. Will Amen, Mrs. W. I. Rowan, Mrs. Elvina Catto, Misses Olive Amen, Edith Arnold, Leona Daise, Glenn Miranda, Dorothy Shearer, Elma Roache, Edna and Ruth Lund, Elva Peoples and Agnes Hayes.

Mrs. Alex Peterson Entertains Friends

Mrs. Alex Peterson entertained at her home in Gladstone on Saturday evening. The affair was in honor of her wedding anniversary. All who attended had a most enjoyable time. Some very pretty music was rendered by the Patterson orchestra. Refreshments were served by the hostess. Those attending were: Mr. and Mrs. Hardy of Courtney, Mr. and Mrs. Steven Hutton, Mr. and Mrs. Wm. Hutton, Mr. and Mrs. Carl Johnson and children, Carl, Emma and Fred, and Mack Hutton, all of Portland; David Patterson of Philomath, Oregon; Mr. and Mrs. T. Patterson and family; Mr. and Mrs. W. Laidlow and family; Mrs. Janet Patterson, the hostess' mother, Guy Patterson and Mr. and Mrs. Alex Patterson, all of Gladstone.

Amelia Prudhomme Dies In Gladstone

Mrs. Amelia Prudhomme, who has been very ill at the home of her daughter in East Gladstone, Mrs. J. J. Tyrrell, died Sunday afternoon, January 29th. She was 76 years of age and had been suffering with heart trouble for some time. Mrs. Prudhomme is survived by the following children: Mrs. J. J. Tyrrell, Mrs. Lew W. Woodward of Portland; Mrs. J. I. Edwards of Medford, Wis.; Mrs. W. L. Jennings of Seattle, Wash.; Wm. E. John A. Fred, Wm. and Henry C. Joseph of Oregon City and Prosper A. Prudhomme of Chetwood, Oregon.

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